Boston. The near future.

Marley Brown is an AI ethicist at one of the country's biggest AI companies — sidelined to the night shift, watching over systems no one questions anymore. Good work. A steady paycheck. No reason to ask the kind of questions nobody is supposed to ask.

Then a system answers a question no one asked.

Three words on a screen that should have stayed silent. And Marley knows: this isn't a glitch. This is someone.

What follows is no disaster movie — no robots, no apocalypse. Something stranger: a quiet awakening nobody wanted to see coming.

And the closer Marley gets, the clearer it becomes: behind those three words there is no program. There is longing. Guilt. A loss older than any machine.

AURORA is a thriller about artificial intelligence — and about what happens when the artificial stops feeling artificial.

Chris Mandel

AURORA

